THE JOPETNAH FOUNDATION

Photography and Video Policy

Building Whole Communities, One Life at a Time.

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Executive Summary

The Jopetnah Foundation (TJF) uses photographs, videos and other visual media to document programme activities, demonstrate impact, support fundraising, strengthen partnerships and increase public awareness.

This Policy establishes standards for capturing, storing, using and sharing visual content while protecting the dignity, privacy, safety and rights of beneficiaries, staff, volunteers and partners.

1. Purpose

This Policy aims to:

- Promote ethical storytelling.
- Protect the rights and dignity of individuals.
- Ensure informed consent.
- Support safeguarding obligations.
- Strengthen public trust.
- Maintain high-quality visual communications.

2. Scope

This Policy applies to:

- Employees.
- Volunteers.
- Consultants.
- Contractors.
- Board members.
- Media representatives working on behalf of TJF.
- Partner organizations producing content for TJF.

It covers:

- Photographs.
- Videos.
- Audio-visual recordings.

- Livestreams.
- Drone imagery (where permitted by law).
- Digital illustrations derived from programme imagery.

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3. Guiding Principles

Visual content should always be:

- Respectful.
- Truthful.
- Dignified.
- Inclusive.
- Accurate.
- Safe.
- Lawful.
- Consistent with TJF's values.

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4. Informed Consent

Consent should be obtained before capturing or publishing identifiable images or recordings where required by law or organizational policy.

Consent should:

- Be voluntary.
- Be informed.
- Clearly explain the intended use.
- Be documented where appropriate.

For children or individuals who cannot legally provide consent, permission should be obtained from a parent, legal guardian or other authorized representative in accordance with applicable laws and safeguarding procedures.

Participants should be informed that declining to be photographed or recorded will not affect their access to TJF services.

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5. Safeguarding

When photographing or filming children and vulnerable individuals:

- Prioritize safety and dignity.
- Avoid exploitative or sensational imagery.
- Never reveal information that could place individuals at risk.
- Follow the TJF Safeguarding Policy at all times.

Images should never expose confidential case information or identifiable details that could compromise safety.

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6. Ethical Storytelling

Visual storytelling should:

- Reflect authentic programme activities.
- Highlight strengths, resilience and achievements.

- Avoid reinforcing stereotypes.
- Present individuals respectfully and accurately.
- Avoid manipulating images in a misleading manner.

Stories should focus on partnership and empowerment rather than dependency.

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7. Image Quality Standards

Official visual content should:

- Be well composed.
- Be in focus.
- Use appropriate lighting where practical.
- Represent programme activities accurately.
- Meet publication quality standards.

Low-resolution or distorted images should not be used in official publications unless no suitable alternative exists.

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8. Copyright and Intellectual Property

Visual content created by or for TJF should be managed in accordance with applicable copyright agreements.

Before using externally supplied photographs or videos:

- Confirm usage rights.
- Obtain any required permissions.
- Credit creators where required.
- Respect applicable license terms.

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9. Storage and Security

Visual media should be stored securely using approved systems.

Files should be:

- Properly named.
- Organized by programme or event.
- Protected from unauthorized access.
- Backed up according to organizational procedures.

Sensitive media should receive additional access controls.

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10. Metadata and Record Keeping

Where practical, maintain records including:

- Date captured.
- Location.
- Photographer or videographer.
- Programme or event.
- Consent status.
- Usage restrictions.

Maintaining metadata improves accountability and future retrieval.

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11. Editing and Alteration

Editing should be limited to legitimate improvements such as:

- Cropping.
- Colour correction.
- Exposure adjustment.
- Minor quality enhancement.

Editing must not:

- Misrepresent events.
- Fabricate situations.
- Alter the meaning of the image.
- Mislead viewers.

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12. Publication and Distribution

Before publication, confirm that:

- Appropriate approvals have been obtained.
- Required consent has been documented.
- Branding complies with TJF standards.
- Captions are accurate.
- Confidential information has been removed or protected.

Visual content may be published through:

- Website.
- Annual reports.
- Social media.
- Newsletters.
- Donor reports.
- Presentations.
- Media releases.
- Educational materials.

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13. Drone Photography

Where drone imagery is used:

- Comply with national aviation regulations.
- Obtain any required permits.
- Respect privacy.
- Avoid restricted areas.
- Assess safety risks before operation.

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14. Artificial Intelligence (AI)

AI-assisted editing may be used for technical improvements such as noise reduction or resolution enhancement.

AI should **not** be used to:

- Fabricate programme activities.
- Generate deceptive images represented as real events.
- Alter the identity or actions of participants.
- Misrepresent programme outcomes.

AI-generated illustrations or conceptual graphics should be clearly distinguishable from documentary photographs.

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15. Roles and Responsibilities

Communications & Public Relations Department

Responsible for:

- Maintaining visual standards.
- Managing visual archives.
- Reviewing publication requests.
- Providing staff guidance.

Programme Teams

Responsible for:

- Coordinating photography during activities.
- Confirming consent requirements.
- Providing accurate captions and context.

All Staff and Volunteers

Individuals should:

- Respect this Policy.
- Protect confidential information.
- Report inappropriate use of visual media.
- Avoid unauthorized publication of programme imagery.

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16. Monitoring and Compliance

Compliance may be monitored through:

- Publication reviews.
- Asset audits.
- Communications assessments.
- Safeguarding reviews.

Any breaches should be addressed promptly and in accordance with TJF policies.

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17. Review

This Policy should be reviewed:

- Every three years.
- Following safeguarding incidents involving visual media.
- After changes in applicable law.
- When new communication technologies are adopted.

Conclusion

Responsible photography and video practices help protect the people TJF serves while strengthening transparency, credibility and public engagement.

By following this Policy, The Jopetnah Foundation demonstrates its commitment to ethical storytelling, safeguarding and respectful communication.

> **Every image should reflect dignity, truth and the shared commitment to sustainable development.**